Yuki Kanayama

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London School of Economics
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Research Interests

Urban Economics, Housing Economics, Applied Microeconometrics, Real Estate, Transport

Affiliation

London School of Economics, UK
Ph.D. Student in Economic Geography — August 2024 – Present
Supervisors: Professor Christian Hilber and Dr Felipe Carozzi

Education

Waseda University, Tokyo, Japan
M.A. in Economics — March 2020
Valedictorian (for the highest academic excellence)
Supervisors: Professor Toshi Arimura and Professor Tadao Hoshino
B.A. in Economics — March 2018
Supervisor: Professor Toshi Arimura

Professional Experience

Ministry of Land, Infrastructure, Transport and Tourism, Government of Japan
On Leave — July 2024 – Present
International Policy and Project Division, Railway Bureau — April 2022 – June 2024
Construction Industry Division, Real Estate and Construction Economy Bureau — April 2020 – March 2022

Peer-Reviewed Publications

[1] What Types of Houses Remain Vacant? Evidence From a Municipality in Tokyo, Japan (with T. Sadayuki). *Journal of the Japanese and International Economies*, 62, 101167, 2021.

[2] The Externality of Vacant Houses: The Case of Toshima Municipality, Tokyo, Japan (with T. Sadayuki and T. Arimura). *Review of Regional Studies*, 50(2), 260–281, 2020.

Work in Progress

[1] Housing Dereliction in a Superstar City: Future Gains, Today's Neglect, and Disamenity Effects (with T. Sadayuki) *LSE Geography and Environment Discussion Paper Series: Papers in Economic Geography and Spatial Economics* No.59 May 2026.

Abstract: Why do derelict houses persist in urban areas despite strong demand? What are their effects on neighbourhoods? This paper proposes a simple mechanism — speculation over future real estate value increases — to explain dereliction amid prosperity and to quantify its disamenity effects. First, we develop a dynamic discrete choice model showing that expectations of future urban regeneration can incentivise property owners to delay redevelopment, thereby prolonging dereliction. Using parcel-level GIS data from central Tokyo, we find that properties located in areas designated for future regeneration are 7–16 percentage points more likely to be derelict. Second, we estimate the effect of derelict houses on nearby rents using future regeneration as an instrument — affecting current rents only through dereliction. Our 2SLS results show that one additional derelict house within 80 metres reduces rents by 1.6% on average. The estimated effect is magnified to 3.6–6.5% in areas with low accessibility to public safety services, suggesting that renters' concerns about fire and crime risks amplify the disamenity effects. Our findings indicate that rational forward-looking behaviour can reduce effective housing supply and generate negative neighbourhood externalities, pointing to unintended consequences of place-based urban policies.

[2] Lot Shape Matters a Lot: The Geometry of Urban Land Market Frictions (with I. Aiba and K. Tanaka) *unpublished manuscript*

Abstract: This study examines whether the geometric characteristics of land lots can be sources of frictions in the land market. We first propose a search-and-matching model of the land market that links shape irregularity to vacancy duration and the likelihood that a lot is put on the market. To test the theoretical predictions, we apply a Cox proportional hazards model for the duration analysis and a linear probability model for the listing decisions analysis to a rich set of GIS polygon data on vacant lots from a satellite city of Tokyo. We find that shape irregularity – measured as the areal deviation from a minimum bounding rectangle – is associated with longer vacancy and lower probability of being listed for sale. The results suggest that lot shape is not merely a passive spatial trait but a structural source of land market frictions, which could hinder the efficient supply of housing in high-demand areas.

[3] The Geographic Determinants of Housing Consumption (with C. Hilber, O. Schöni and X. Yu)

Presentations

2026 (including scheduled ones): CREST Urban Workshop, European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society, 20th North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association; 16th Geoffrey J.D. Hewings Workshop in Regional Economics; Workshop at the University of Tokyo; Empirical Microeconomics Seminar at Waseda University; Research Seminar at Ritsumeikan University; University of Reading Workshop in Urban Economics and Economic Geography

2025: Workshop at the University of Tokyo; AREUEA International Conference at IESE Business School; University of Reading Workshop in Urban Economics and Economic Geography; Land Economy Early Career/PhD/Post-Doc Student Conference at the University of Cambridge; Doctorissimes at the Paris School of Economics

2024: Applied Regional Economics Workshop at Kyoto Sangyo University

2023: Applied Regional Science Conference at the University of Osaka; CSIS Days at the University of Tokyo; IDE School in Applied Econometrics for Spatial and Urban Economics at the Institute of Developing Economies; Workshop at Japan Women's University

2022: Housing Economy Workshop at the Housing Research and Advancement Foundation of Japan

2019: Society for Environmental Economics and Policy Studies Annual Conference at Fukushima University

2018: Workshop at Japan Women's University; Society of Environmental Science Annual Conference at Toyo University

Awards

[1] Outstanding Joint-Research Award, Center for Spatial Information Science, The University of Tokyo, November 2023

[2] Dean's Academic Award for the Best Master's Dissertation, Waseda University, March 2020

[3] Outstanding Presentation Award, Society of Environmental Science, Japan, September 2018

Grants

[1] Obayashi Foundation, April 2026 – March 2027
A Project on Supply Effects of Vacant Housing

[2] Murata Science and Education Foundation, June 2025 – May 2027
A Project on Vacant Land (with I. Aiba and K. Tanaka)

[3] Center for Spatial Information Science, The University of Tokyo, April 2024 – March 2025
A Project on Housing Externalities (with T. Sadayuki)

Scholarship

[1] British Council Japan Association Scholarship, September 2024

Research Assistantships

Housing Research and Advancement Foundation of Japan
RA for Dr Chigusa Okamoto, Dr Taisuke Sadayuki, and Dr Takeru Sugasawa April 2025 – Present

Waseda University
RA for Professor Toshi Arimura April 2019 – August 2019
RA for Dr Hiroki Onuma April 2019 – August 2019

Teaching Experience

London School of Economics
GY210 The Economics of Cities (Class Teacher) January 2026 – August 2026
Course Convenor: Professor Henry Overman
GY447 The Economics of Regional and Urban Planning (Presessional Course Teacher) September 2025
Course Convenor: Dr Felipe Carozzi

Miscellaneous

[1] Overview of Railway Projects in Thailand. *The Japan Railway Technical Service Bulletin* (in Japanese), 9–14, 2023.

[2] Determinants of Vacant Housing Occurrence and Reutilisation (with T. Sadayuki). *Quarterly Journal of Housing and Land Economics* (in Japanese), 126, 28–35, 2022.

[3] Bringing Vacant Houses Back as Private Lodging for the Tokyo 2020 Olympics: Ensuring Accommodation Capacity and Alleviating the Negative Externality (with T. Sadayuki). *Environmental Economics and Policy Studies* (in Japanese), 12(1), 67–70, 2019.

[4] Vacant Houses and Road Construction (with T. Sadayuki). In T. H. Arimura (Ed.), *Research on Social Infrastructure for Sustainable Local Economic Development* (Report No. A-716, in Japanese). The Japan Research Center for Transport Policy, 31–54, 2018.

Media Coverage

[1] Toyo Keizai (web magazine), June 2026

[2] Jutaku Simpo (newspaper), September 2023

[3] Waseda Weekly (web magazine), December 2018

Other Affiliations

Waseda University
Fellow, Research Institute for Environmental Economics and Management February 2026 – Present

The University of Tokyo
Visiting Researcher, Center for Real Estate Innovation April 2025 – Present

Other Information

Minor	Urban and Regional Studies, Waseda University, March 2018
Skills	R, Stata, ArcGIS, Python, SQL
Languages	English, Japanese (native)
Date of Birth	7th April 1995
Half Marathon	1:13:40 (Fukaya, Japan)